Yucca rostrata

Beaked Yucca, Big Bend Yucca

Also known as: Silver Yucca | Family: Asparagaceae (formerly Agavaceae)



HABIT



OTHER



LEAF



OTHER

QUICK FACTS

Plant Type: Tree

Evergreen or deciduous
Evergreen

Growth & Size
Rate: Not stated
Size: Trunk to 12–15 ft (3.5–4.5 m) high with crown of leaves; overall plant taller with flower spike. arborescent succulent.
Rosettes of more than 100 leaves

Sun

Water

Soil
Freely draining sandy, gritty, or rocky soils.
Avoid poor drainage

Zone 8a
Hardy in USDA Zones 5–12. Suitable for Atlanta Zone 8a in full sun with excellent drainage. Protect from winter winds in cooler microclimates if needed. Architectural evergreen form. White flower panicles in late spring/summer.
Low maintenance once established

ORIGIN AND CHARACTERISTICS

Origin
Native to western Texas (Big Bend region, Brewster County) and northern Mexico (Chihuahua, Coahuila).
Arid desert and steppe environments with low rainfall

Form
Evergreen tree-like succulent with trunk and dense crown of thin, stiff, bluish-green linear leaves (to 60 cm long, <2 cm wide) with yellow margins and sharp tips. Large panicle of white flowers (up to 1 m). Persistent leaf bases on trunk. Architectural form. No significant fall color (evergreen). One of the hardiest trunk-forming yuccas. Distinctive blue-green foliage and white flower spikes. Excellent for arid or well-drained sites. Popular in desert and increasingly in eastern landscapes. Architectural form. Sharp tips.
Native to Big Bend region

Foliage
Not stated

Flowers and fruit
Not stated

Bark
Not stated

PLANTING NOTES

Establishment

Plant in full sun with excellent drainage. Water deeply but infrequently once established. Minimal care. Excellent architectural specimen for dry or xeriscape plantings. Protect from excessive winter moisture or wind if needed.
Propagate by seed or offsets

HEALTH

Health

Generally pest-free and disease-free when properly drained. Extremely drought tolerant. Sharp leaf tips require care around children or high-traffic areas. Low maintenance.
Cold hardy for a trunk-forming yucca

Symptoms

None stated